

Improving access to imported food safety requirements

Imported food safety requirements are now included in the [Biosecurity Import Conditions system \(BICON\)](#).

See more about the [Inclusion of food safety requirements in BICON](#).

All biosecurity requirements must be met before [Imported Food Inspection Scheme](#) requirements apply.

Check our [Biosecurity Import Conditions system \(BICON\)](#) for biosecurity import conditions.

We classify imported food that presents a potential medium or high risk to public health as [risk food](#). All risk food is listed in the [Imported Food Control Order 2019](#).

Crustaceans and crustacean products that are cooked and ready-to-eat are risk food

This includes, but is not limited to, cooked and [ready-to-eat](#):

- Crab
- Crayfish
- Prawn or shrimp

Exclusions

Crustaceans and crustacea products that are:

- [retorted](#) and [shelf stable](#)
- dried
- from [New Zealand](#).

Declaring certificates

When lodging a [Full Import Declaration \(FID\)](#), use the correct ICS document code and certificate number for the food.

See [lodging declarations and documentation](#).

Community Protection (CP) question

You will need to answer this CP question when lodging your [full import declaration](#):

IFIS: Are the goods cooked crustaceans that require refrigeration (chilled or frozen) and do not require further cooking before consumption? (Answer 'no' if the goods are crumbed or battered).

Inspection and testing

We refer consignments of cooked crustaceans and crustacea products that are ready-to-eat for analytical testing. During inspection, we will also conduct a visual and label assessment.

Testing for *Listeria monocytogenes* applies to cooked crustaceans that are ready-to-eat at a rate based on the compliance history of the particular food.

Testing for *Salmonella* applies at the rate of 5%.

Additional requirements apply to specific seafood. See [fish and crustaceans from aquaculture production](#).

Table 1 shows the tests that will be applied and permitted results for each food type.

Table 1, Food type, test applied and permitted results

Food type	Test applied	Permitted result
	<i>Listeria monocytogenes</i>	
Cooked crustaceans that are ready-to-eat	Note: An IFIS Importer declaration can be lodged for this food where it does not support the growth of <i>Listeria monocytogenes</i> .	n=5, c=0, m= not detected in 25 g
Cooked crustaceans that are ready-to-eat	<i>Salmonella</i>	n=5, c=0, m= not detected in 25 g
Prawns and shrimp	<i>Vibrio cholerae</i>	n=5, c=0, m= not detected in 25 g

n = the number of samples to be analysed from a lot of food.

c = the maximum number of sample units that can be greater than ‘m’.

m = the acceptable microbiological level in a sample unit.

Food safety risks

Food Standard Australia New Zealand (FSANZ) has given us [advice about the risk of cooked crustaceans that are ready-to-eat](#) and support the growth of *Listeria monocytogenes*. These products present a potential medium or high risk to public health and safety for *Listeria monocytogenes*.

FSANZ has also advised that ready-to-eat cooked prawns and shrimp present a potential medium or high risk for *Vibrio cholerae*.

Voluntary foreign government certification arrangements

We have a [voluntary certification arrangement](#) in place with Canada and Thailand for cooked crustaceans that are ready-to-eat. Consignments of these foods from Canada and Thailand with a recognised government certificate have a reduced rate of inspection and testing.

Certificate requirements

Type of information	To include
National competent authority:	Canadian Food Inspection Agency
Recognised certificate title	Certificate of Origin and Hygiene
ICS document code:	CI

Certificate requirements

Type of information	To include
National competent authority:	Ministry of Agriculture and Cooperatives – Department of Fisheries
Recognised certificate titles:	
Additional requirement:	The certificate must identify that the food has been sourced from an establishment approved by the Department of Fisheries, Thailand .
ICS document code:	DOFHCTH

Glossary

Ready-to-eat

Food is ready-to-eat if it is ordinarily consumed in the same state as that in which it is sold.

To avoid doubt, food is not ordinarily consumed in the same state as that in which it is sold if, before it is consumed, it requires further processing (such as cooking) to reduce any pathogenic microorganisms potentially present in the food to safe levels.

Retorted

Animal products are retorted if they are heated in a hermetically sealed container to a minimum core temperature of 100°C, obtaining an Fo value of at least 2.8.

Shelf stable

Goods are shelf stable if the:

- goods have been commercially manufactured
- goods have been packaged by the manufacturer
- goods are in that package
- package has not been opened or broken
- goods are able to be stored in the package at room or ambient temperature, and
- goods do not require refrigeration or freezing before the package is opened.

Version history

Date	Amendment details
23/01/2025	Amend the detail in this webpage to support the splitting of fish and crustaceans from aquaculture production.
23/05/2023	Amend the webpage to update link to IFIS Importer declaration.
12/04/2023	Amend the webpage to update the link to the list of fish processing establishments approved by the Department of Fisheries, Thailand.
10/11/2020	Removed tests for coagulase-positive staphylococci and Standard Plate Count (SPC). Test for <i>Listeria monocytogenes</i> increased to risk rate. Test for salmonella sp. reduced to surveillance rate.
25/03/2019	Added tests for <i>Listeria monocytogenes</i> .
16/11/2018	Consolidates risk food webpage for cooked prawns and shrimp.
1/5/2014	Replaces Imported Food Notice 09/12 Tests applied to risk category foods.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/import/goods/food/type/cooked-crustaceans>